



HARVESTING

Early turnips will be ready to harvest within about five to six weeks, and larger maincrop varieties in about 10. Harvest by late fall, since the roots risk becoming woody if left in the ground for too long. Pick the “turnip tops” when leaves are still young, about 5–6 in (13–15 cm) tall. If kept well-watered, the tops will usually crop a couple of times.

STORING

Turnips have a relatively high water content and do not store well. Harvest as needed and use them as soon as possible.

PESTS AND DISEASES

Like rutabagas, turnips are members of the brassica family and fall prey to the same pests and diseases (see pp.246–7). Sow seeds under fine mesh to prevent attack from cabbage root fly and flea beetles. Also watch out for diseases such as clubroot and downy mildew.



Clubroot stunts growth and kills crops.